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Florida Beach Towns Ranked by Flood Risk

50 Florida beach towns, ranked on how much land floods when the tide runs 3 feet above normal and how much sits in FEMA's official high-risk flood zone.

Highest flood risk (top 5)		Lowest flood risk (safest 5)	
1. Anna Maria	9.9	50. Stuart	1.5
2. Marathon	9.7	49. Fort Walton Beach	1.9
3. Sanibel	9.3	48. Melbourne	2.1
4. Fort Myers Beach	9.0	47. Jupiter	2.2
5. Islamorada	8.6	46. Palm Bay	2.3

Combined Flood Score: 1 = lowest risk, 10 = highest risk, relative to the other 49 towns on this list. The safest 5 are listed from lowest score up.

Colors used in this guide

+1 ft above recent normal high tide | +2 ft | +3 ft | FEMA high-risk zone

Prepared November 2026 by FloridaCoastal.co from NOAA, FEMA and US Census public data.

Why flood risk belongs on your list

Choosing a Florida beach town is about the life you want: morning walks on the sand, a good fish taco, friends nearby and a pace that suits you. But the same water that makes these towns beautiful can also come into the streets. Before you fall in love with a neighborhood, it is worth knowing how often the ocean is likely to visit it, and how the federal government officially maps its flood risk.

This guide looks at two different kinds of flood risk. The first is the ocean itself: everyday high tides, the extra-high "King Tides" that flood some streets on sunny fall days, and storm surge pushed ashore by hurricanes. The second is FEMA's official high-risk flood map, the one lenders use. The two do not always agree, so we combine them into one simple score from 1 to 10.

Use the ranking as one piece of the puzzle, not the whole answer. A town near the top can still be a wonderful fit if you choose higher ground, a newer elevated home or a condo above the ground floor. A town near the bottom still floods in some spots. Pair this list with what matters most to you, and look at the exact street before you buy.

> **Quick tip:** Not sure which towns fit your lifestyle yet? Take the free 8-question beach town quiz at FloridaCoastal.co, then check your matches here. No sales calls.

How to read this guide

Tide Flooding (the ocean coming in)

How much of a town goes underwater when the tide rises 1, 2 or 3 feet above recent normal high tide (MHHW). It shows which streets flood on sunny King Tide days and in storm surge. Only land connected to the ocean is counted. The ranking uses the +3 ft figure.

Example: Marathon **57.9%**



24.8% under water at +1 ft, 37.4% at +2 ft, 57.9% at +3 ft

Light blue = land under water at +1 ft, medium blue = added at +2 ft, dark blue = added at +3 ft. The bar length is the +3 ft total.

FEMA High-Risk Zone (the official map)

The share of a town inside FEMA's Special Flood Hazard Area: land with at least a 1% chance of flooding in any year, where mortgages require flood insurance. Zones A and AE are mostly rain and river flooding; Zone VE is coastal storm surge with waves.

FEMA's map does not include normal daily tides or future sea level rise, which is why it can tell a different story from the tide map.

Combined Flood Score (1 to 10)

Both measures above, given equal weight, turned into one score where 10 is the highest risk among these 50 towns. The next page shows exactly how it works.

How the Combined Score works

The score compares each town to the other 49 on this list. It is a ranking, not a prediction of whether a particular home will flood. Here are the three steps:

1. **Rank on tide flooding.** Each town gets a percentile from 0 to 100 based on how much of its land is under water at +3 ft above recent normal high tide (100 = the most).

2. **Rank on the FEMA map.** Each town gets a second percentile from 0 to 100 based on how much of its land is in FEMA's high-risk zone. Towns that tie share the same percentile.

3. **Average and scale.** The two percentiles are averaged with equal weight and scaled to 1-10: score = 1 + 9 x (average / 100). 10 = highest risk.

Worked example: Santa Rosa Beach (30A)

Land under water at +3 ft: **7.4%**

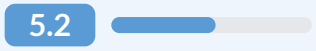
Tide percentile: **38.8**

Land in FEMA high-risk zone: **53.5%**

FEMA percentile: **55.1**

Average: (38.8 + 55.1) / 2 = **46.95**

Score: 1 + 9 x 0.4695 = 5.23, rounds to **5.2** (rank 29)



In plain English: Santa Rosa Beach has less tide-prone land than most towns on the list, a bit more FEMA high-risk land than average, and lands right in the middle at 5.2.

Good to know

- Elevation is shown in the source spreadsheet for information only. It is not part of the score.

- Neither map counts heavy-rain flooding, like Palm Bay's Nov 2, 2026 deluge. A low score does not mean a street never floods in a downpour.

All 50 towns, ranked

Highest risk first. Tide bar: light / medium / dark blue = under water at +1 / +2 / +3 ft above recent normal high tide (MHHW).

Rank	Town	Combined score (1-10)	% land under water at +3 ft	% land in FEMA high-risk zone
1	Anna Maria	9.9	47.2%	99.9%
2	Marathon	9.7	57.9%	99.8%
3	Sanibel	9.3	46.1%	99.6%
4	Fort Myers Beach	9.0	36.5%	99.8%
5	Islamorada	8.6	46.3%	91.0%
6	Bradenton Beach	8.6	33.6%	98.4%
7	Miami Beach	8.5	40.4%	95.3%
8	Marco Island	8.5	39.9%	95.8%
9	Key West	8.3	42.5%	88.3%
10	Treasure Island	8.3	19.0%	99.9%
11	Cedar Key	8.2	41.6%	87.1%
12	St. Pete Beach	8.2	20.3%	99.8%
13	Navarre Beach	7.9	23.0%	96.8%
14	Siesta Key	7.6	15.5%	98.1%
15	Longboat Key	7.5	22.7%	95.0%
16	St. Augustine	7.1	26.2%	59.7%
17	Pensacola Beach	7.1	14.8%	93.1%
18	Flagler Beach	6.4	29.9%	45.4%
19	Palm Beach	6.4	13.4%	62.7%
20	Naples	6.3	11.1%	76.9%
21	Cocoa Beach	6.2	31.7%	44.4%
22	Jacksonville Beach	5.8	24.7%	38.9%
23	Apalachicola	5.8	23.3%	44.0%
24	Hallandale Beach	5.8	7.7%	71.1%
25	New Smyrna Beach	5.5	10.8%	50.4%

All 50 towns, ranked (continued)

Highest risk first. Tide bar: light / medium / dark blue = under water at +1 / +2 / +3 ft above recent normal high tide (MHHW).

Rank	Town	Combined score (1-10)	% land under water at +3 ft	% land in FEMA high-risk zone
26	Hollywood	5.5	10.6%	51.2%
27	Fort Lauderdale	5.4	5.0%	60.5%
28	Cape Coral	5.2	13.1%	44.6%
29	Santa Rosa Beach (30A)	5.2	7.4%	53.5%
30	Ormond Beach	4.8	11.9%	33.3%
31	Mexico Beach	4.4	1.0%	55.4%
32	Fernandina Beach	4.2	8.9%	26.7%
33	Sarasota	3.7	4.1%	25.8%
34	Vero Beach	3.6	8.1%	18.4%
35	Pompano Beach	3.6	1.0%	44.9%
36	Daytona Beach	3.5	0.5%	50.1%
37	Panama City Beach	3.3	0.3%	50.1%
38	Clearwater	3.1	2.9%	19.0%
39	Venice	3.1	1.6%	23.6%
40	West Palm Beach	3.1	0.3%	47.4%
41	Satellite Beach	2.7	3.7%	10.2%
42	Fort Pierce	2.7	1.6%	15.9%
43	Boca Raton	2.6	0.8%	25.7%
44	Destin	2.5	1.1%	16.2%
45	Delray Beach	2.4	1.5%	13.1%
46	Palm Bay	2.3	0.2%	29.3%
47	Jupiter	2.2	1.6%	8.8%
48	Melbourne	2.1	0.4%	20.7%
49	Fort Walton Beach	1.9	0.9%	11.8%
50	Stuart	1.5	0.7%	4.3%

Where the maps disagree

The two maps measure different things, so a few towns rank very differently on each. "pct" = percentile, comparing each town with the other 49 (100 = most land affected).

FEMA map shows more risk than the tide map

Little land sits within 3 ft of high tide, but FEMA maps sizable rain, river, lake or surge zones.

Town	Tide (+3 ft) · pct	FEMA · pct
Panama City Beach (rank 37)	0.3% · pct 4	50.1% · pct 48
West Palm Beach (rank 40)	0.3% · pct 2	47.4% · pct 45
Daytona Beach (rank 36)	0.5% · pct 8	50.1% · pct 48
Mexico Beach (rank 31)	1.0% · pct 18	55.4% · pct 57
Palm Bay (rank 46)	0.2% · pct 0	29.3% · pct 29

Tide map shows more risk than the FEMA map

These towns rank much higher on low, ocean-connected land than on FEMA's high-risk map.

Town	Tide (+3 ft) · pct	FEMA · pct
Cocoa Beach (rank 21)	31.7% · pct 80	44.4% · pct 37
Jacksonville Beach (rank 22)	24.7% · pct 74	38.9% · pct 33
Apalachicola (rank 23)	23.3% · pct 71	44.0% · pct 35
Flagler Beach (rank 18)	29.9% · pct 78	45.4% · pct 43

Neither map counts heavy-rain flooding, like Palm Bay's Nov 2, 2026 deluge.

Sources and notes

- **Tide flooding:** NOAA Office for Coastal Management, Sea Level Rise Viewer (+1, +2 and +3 ft above recent normal high tide, MHHW; ocean-connected areas only).
- **FEMA high-risk zone:** FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer (Special Flood Hazard Area: A, AE, VE and similar).
- **Town boundaries:** US Census boundaries (TIGERweb 2026 places). Santa Rosa Beach (30A) = ZIP 32459; Pensacola Beach = ZIP 32561 on Santa Rosa Island.
- Scores rank these 50 towns against each other; they are not a guarantee for any single property.